CUB SCOUT PACK 361 · ELLICOTT CITY, MD

The Pack 361 App Guide

Part 1 is for every family: getting started, everyday use, privacy and help. Part 2 is for the pack's leaders: running events and den meetings, advancement, money, expenses, reports and pack admin.

NEW IN VERSION 3.0

Families: a Getting started list, Add to my calendar, the weather on event pages, RSVP waitlists, reminders and advancement alerts, a pack Gear closet, Help wanted and a printable season keepsake. Photos are now OK unless you opt out. Leaders: Build this event, copy and repeating events, a Ready to go? check, messages to who hasn't answered, and weather alerts. Version history is on the last page.

Open it at

app.pack361.org

Latest copy: app.pack361.org/app-guide · Questions: info@pack361.org

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INSIDE

What's in this guide

The Pack 361 app puts everything a pack family needs in one place: the calendar and RSVPs, campout details, paying the pack, your scout's advancement, announcements from leaders, photos, paperwork, pack documents and more. It's private: only families and leaders on the pack roster can sign in.

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Tags in Part 2: LEADERS den leaders, key leaders, Cubmaster, admins · KEY LEADERS+ key leaders, Cubmaster, admins · ADMINS pack admins and the Cubmaster

PART 1

For every family

Everything a pack family does in the app, from putting it on your phone to RSVPs, campouts, paying the pack and keeping your scout's forms handy. Leaders: start here too.

1.1 Getting started	Two minutes, no app store
1.2 Finding your way around	The five tabs, search, Pack and Me
1.3 Using the app	Everything you'll do week to week
1.4 Privacy and youth protection	What the pack keeps and who sees it
1.5 Help and troubleshooting	When something doesn't work

PART 1 · SECTION 1.1

Getting started

It takes about two minutes. There's nothing to download from an app store: the app runs from your phone's home screen like any other app.

Your sign-in

app.pack361.org

Sign in with **the email address the pack has on file for you** (the one this guide was sent to). There's no password.

1. Put it on your phone

Scan the **"Get the pack app" QR code** at a pack meeting, or open **app.pack361.org/get** on your phone, then:

- **iPhone, Safari:** tap the **Share** button (the square with an arrow) at the bottom of the screen, then **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.
- **iPhone, Chrome:** tap the **Share** button at the right end of the address bar at the top, scroll down, then **Add to Home Screen**. It isn't in Chrome's ⋯ menu.
- **Android:** tap **Install the Pack 361 app**. No button? Tap the ⋮ menu, then **Add to Home screen** or **Install app**.
- **Computer:** it works in any browser. Just bookmark it.

Then open **Pack 361** from the new icon on your home screen.

2. Sign in with a code

1. Enter your email address and tap **Email me a sign-in link and code**.
2. Check your email for **"Pack 361 sign-in code: 123456"**. The code is in the subject line, so it often shows right in your phone's notification.
3. Type the 6-digit code into the app. You stay signed in from then on.

Using the home-screen app? Always type the code. On phones, a link in an email opens your web browser, never the home-screen app. If you tap the link, the app shows a page telling you to go back and type the code instead. On a computer, tapping the link opens a page with **Sign in here**; one more click signs you in.

3. Turn on alerts (optional)

Go to **Me** → **Phone alerts** and tap to turn on phone alerts. You'll get pack announcements, messages to your den, new polls, event reminders, news about your scout's advancement, and reminders for jobs you volunteer for. On iPhone, alerts only work from the home-screen app.

4. Work through your Getting started list

New families (your first 90 days) see a **Getting started** list at the top of Home: Scouting America registration, medical forms, pack dues, phone alerts, adding the pack calendar, reading the welcome guide and meeting your den leader. The first four tick themselves once they're done; tap the circle next to the other three yourself. Tap **Hide this list** to put it away. Home also shows anything else that needs you, like a permission slip or a quick poll.

PART 1 · SECTION 1.2

Finding your way around

Five tabs that never move: along the bottom on a phone, down the left on a computer. Everything else is one tap into **Pack** or **Me**, and the magnifier at the top searches the whole app.

Home	Calendar	Scouts	Pack	Me
What's next, your to-dos, your scouts, pack news	Events, campouts, den meetings, RSVPs	Rank progress; report what your scout finished	Pay, store, guide, documents, gear closet, photos, polls, help wanted	Family and registration, medical forms, settings, help

The pack's next big event (a campout, a derby, Blue & Gold, crossover) is pinned at the top of Home and Calendar from about six weeks before. The **Calendar** has quick filters: Campouts, Big events, Den meetings. Leaders start on **My dens** (their own scouts' dens); **All** shows every den.

Search and the bell (top right)

The **magnifier** finds anything: an event, "dues", "popcorn", "medical forms", a leader's name. The **bell** has pack news, messages to your den and everything waiting on you; the red number shows what's new.

Me

Short pages for each thing: **Family and registration** (and photos), **Payments**, **Medical forms**, **Saved on this phone**, **Phone alerts**, **My contact info**, and **Report a problem or send a note**. **Appearance** turns dark mode on, off, or to match your phone. Sign out is at the bottom.

Pack

Pay the pack and **Get paid back**; the **popcorn fundraiser**, pack apparel and uniforms; the **Pack guide**, **Documents**, **Gear closet**, **Photos**, **Polls** and news; **Leader contacts**, **Invite a family** and **Help wanted**.

Leaders: Family or Leader

Leaders get a **Family / Leader** switch (top of Home on a phone, bottom of the sidebar on a computer). Leader mode is where leaders start, with a **Now viewing in Leader mode** bar across the top; it shows what's waiting on you on Home, your dens on Scouts, and leader tools in Pack (2.1). Family lasts 12 hours or until you next sign in.

Using the app

Calendar and RSVPs

- You see pack-wide events plus your scouts' own den meetings and den events. Den meetings held somewhere else show the location and address.
- **RSVP right in the app**, for every event including den meetings. Tap **RSVP**, choose Going, Maybe or Can't go, and say how many scouts and adults are coming. After that the button shows your answer everywhere the event appears; tap it to change. Driving somewhere? Campouts, outings and off-site den meetings have a **Carpool** section: post seats to share or ask for a ride. Everyone sees the headcount; leaders see who's coming. Change your answer any time until the RSVP date.
- **Answer right from Home or the bell.** Special events coming up soon (not regular meetings) show as a card with **Going**, **Maybe** and **Can't make it**. Going counts your scouts and one adult; open the event to change the numbers. **Maybe** hides the card until the morning of the event, then it asks again. If an event has a cost, Going opens the event so you can say how many are coming, and it's added to what you owe.
- Polls and volunteer jobs have **Not now** if you want them out of the way: a poll comes back a day before it closes, a job two days before its event. Money due, medical forms and registration stay until they're done.
- **Add the pack calendar to your phone:** at the bottom of the Calendar, one tap subscribes your phone's calendar app, and it stays up to date. The link is private to your family; if you share it by mistake, tap **Get a new link** there. Just one event? Tap **Add to my calendar** on its page.
- **Signal group:** if an event has one, RSVP Going and its page shows **Join the Signal group**.
- Past events, and events taken off the calendar, are in **Events → Past events and archive**, by year.

Spots left and the waitlist

Some events have room for only so many people (scouts and adults together). The RSVP card shows **3 spots left**, or **Full**. Say Going when it's full, or when your group doesn't fit, and you join the waitlist: **Full: you're on the waitlist (#2)**. If a spot opens, you're moved in automatically, in order, and get a **You're in!** alert. Nothing to pay unless you get in.

Reminders

The day before an event you said Going to, you get a reminder with the time and place (and, for a campout, what to bring). Two days before an event's RSVP-by date, families who haven't answered get a nudge. Den meetings don't send either. No phone alerts? You get an email instead.

Weather

From a week before an event or campout, its page shows the National Weather Service forecast for the event's address, day by day, with the chance of rain and the wind. Any watch or warning there shows at the top in red; tap **What the Weather Service says** for what to do. While the event is happening, a **Right now** line shows the latest temperature and conditions nearby.

Campouts and hikes also get a **Trail guide**, and **Pack → Nature ID** has the same tools anytime. **Listen for birds** names birds by their song, with a photo of each, right on your phone (the first time downloads the bird sounds, about 56 MB, best on Wi-Fi; after that it works with no signal, and the sound never leaves your phone). **Identify a plant** names a plant from a close photo of a leaf, flower or bark (needs signal). Below them: photos of the birds and plants people have spotted near there that month.

Permission slips

If an event needs one, its page shows the wording, and Home reminds you once you've said Going. Tick your scouts, type your full name, tick that you agree and tap **Sign**; the app keeps your name, the date and the wording. Prefer paper? Print the form and hand it to a leader.

Campouts

- Each campout has its own page: schedule, what to bring, rules, links to sign up and pay, and volunteer jobs.
- The **packing checklist** lets you check items off as you pack. Under **No signal at camp?** tap **Save**, and the page works at camp without signal.
- Some sections are **tap-to-check lists**, like a scavenger hunt: tick things off on your phone as you find them. They work without signal too.
- Every camper, adults too, needs a current medical form. See *Paperwork* below.

Advancement

- Your scout's page shows their rank, which adventures and requirements are done, and what's left, from Scoutbook (the official Scouting America record).
- Did a requirement at home? Open the adventure, check it off and send it. Your den leader approves it, and it's entered in Scoutbook.
- The same page shows **attendance** for the season (den meetings, pack events) and **camping nights**, this season and all time.
- **Alerts:** after a den meeting, "Today the Wolves worked on…". If your scout missed it, you get how to finish that adventure at home instead. You also hear when a leader approves or returns something you reported (with their note), and when the weekly Scoutbook update shows a new adventure or rank.
- **Season keepsake (print)**, on your scout's page: one page with the season's rank, adventures, awards, den meetings, pack events, camping nights and a few pack photos. Pick a past season if you like, then **Print keepsake**.

Volunteering and Help wanted

Events and campouts list jobs (setup, cooking, check-in), and open spots show on Home. Sign up in one tap and you'll get a reminder. Other families see only your first name and last initial. Bigger jobs for the year (popcorn, Blue & Gold) are on **Pack → Help wanted**: tap **I can help**, add a note if you like, and a key leader will reach out. Changed your mind? **Take back my offer**.

The pack gear closet

1. Go to **Pack → Gear closet** to see the tents, camp stoves and other gear the pack lends, and how many are free now.
2. Tap an item, then under **Ask to borrow** say how many, the pack event it's for (optional), when you'd pick it up and the day you'll bring it back. Tap **Send request**.
3. Your request shows at the top: **Waiting**, then **Ready to pick up** (or **Declined**), **Picked up** and **Returned**. You get an alert with the answer.

Plans changed? **Cancel request** until you pick it up. Past the bring-back day, the app sends a reminder every few days until it's back.

Pack photos

- The album is organized by event and only visible to signed-in pack families.
- Scouts may appear in the album unless their family opts out: **Me → Family and registration → Photos**, then **Opt out** (or **Allow photos** to undo it), for each scout, any time. Upload from any event page (**Take or add photos**), up to 20 at a time. A leader checks each photo before it appears.
- Swipe or use the arrows for the next photo; pinch or double-tap to zoom. See a photo that shouldn't be there? Tap **Request removal**. It's hidden right away, and a leader removes it.

Paying the pack

- **Pay the pack** (under Pack, on Me, and in the bell when something is due) lists everything your family owes the pack: pack dues and campout or event costs.
- **Pack dues** are paid on Givebutter, as before: tap **Pay dues on Givebutter**. Your payment is matched to your scouts and shows as paid within a day.
- Other fees can be paid with **PayPal, Venmo (on phones) or a card** when the pack turns that on.
- **Scouting America registration** is renewed and paid at **my.scouting.org**, not to the pack. Me shows when each registration expires, and the app reminds you before it does.
- Paid by check or cash? Tap **I paid another way**, and the treasurer confirms it when the money arrives.

Getting paid back for pack purchases

1. Go to **Pack → Get paid back for pack purchases**, then **Ask to be paid back**.
2. Say what you bought, the amount and the date on the receipt. If you know them, add the store, the event or den it was for, and the budget category (or leave it for the treasurer).
3. Choose how you'd like to be paid back (check, cash, PayPal, Zelle, Venmo or something else), tap **Add the receipt** to snap a photo or pick a PDF, then **Send to the treasurer**.

Send receipts **within 30 days**. You can change or withdraw a request until the treasurer acts on it, and you'll get an alert and an email when it's paid or declined. Never put bank account numbers in the note.

Paperwork: medical forms

- **Me → Medical forms** lists each scout and adult with their medical form status (Parts A and B, good for 12 months).
- Give the paper form to a leader, then tap **I turned it in** with the date on the form. A leader confirms it.
- **Never upload a medical form to the app.** The app only records that the form is on file and when it expires.
- **Keep your own copy on your phone:** Me → **Saved on this phone** stores a photo or PDF of your forms and insurance cards on your phone only. The pack never sees it. On iPhone, use the home-screen app for this (Safari tabs clear saved files after 7 days unused), and keep a backup with **Share → Save to Files**. Signing out doesn't remove them, so delete them first on a shared device.

Pack documents

The **Documents** page has forms, packing lists, minutes and other pack papers. Tap **Open** or **Download**.

Announcements, den messages and polls

Leaders post to the whole pack or to your scout's den. Both show in the bell and on Home, and leaders can also send them by email. Polls ask quick questions (like which weekend works for a campout). Answer, then see the results.

The Sunday email

Every adult gets one email on Sunday mornings: the next two weeks of events with your RSVP, anything waiting on you, announcements and open volunteer jobs. **Your scout this week** shows how far along the rank is, the adventure closest to done (with an idea to try at home), anything a leader approved or returned, and the next den meeting. **Help wanted** lists the pack's open jobs.

Invite a family

Most families join because a friend asked. **Invite a family** (under Pack) has a ready-to-send message with a link to our public page: edit it, then share, text or email it (on Android, pick people from your contacts; their numbers never reach the pack). There's also a QR code, a printable flyer, and the big events visiting families are welcome at.

Privacy and youth protection

Youth protection

- **No one-on-one digital contact.** There is no private messaging. Leaders post to the whole pack or to one den's parents, and nothing is ever sent to scouts. Parents can't message each other through the app.
- **Scouts don't have accounts.** Only parents, guardians and registered leaders on the pack roster can sign in.
- Campout pages list the pack's rules, including two-deep leadership, no one-on-one contact and family-only tenting.

Who sees what

- No family information is public. Public pages (welcome, joining, Safety, Get the app) have only general pack information. Everything else needs an account, and search engines are told not to list it.
- Only key leaders, the Cubmaster and admins see what families owe and pay, and everyone's reimbursement requests. Den leaders and other parents don't. You see your own requests and receipts.
- Families see only their own scouts' information and advancement. Leaders see the roster and medical-form status (never form contents) to keep scouts safe.
- Parents' phone numbers and emails aren't shown to other parents. The leader directory lists only leaders.
- Den messages and den polls are visible only to that den's families and leaders. Poll results show names only to leaders.

What we keep, and what we don't

We keep

Parent and leader names, emails and phone numbers; scout names, dens and member IDs; advancement from Scoutbook; attendance at den meetings, pack events and campouts; training dates; registration expiration dates; volunteer sign-ups; whether each medical form is on file and when it expires; what each family owes and has paid (amounts, dates, PayPal, Givebutter, check or cash); reimbursement requests and their receipts; RSVPs; poll answers; gear you borrow; Help wanted offers; Givebutter orders; pack photos and pack documents.

We don't keep

Birthdates, home addresses, medical forms or any medical information, card or bank details (PayPal and Givebutter handle payments) or passwords. Files you save on your phone stay on your phone; the pack never sees them.

Photos

- Photos are resized, and their location (GPS) and camera data removed, before they're stored. They're deleted automatically after 24 months.
- Scouts may appear unless their family opts out (Me → Family and registration → Photos). A leader approves every photo a parent uploads, and doesn't approve photos showing scouts whose families opted out.
- First names only in captions; no photos where a full name, school or address can be read. Anyone can request removal, and the photo is hidden right away. Please don't repost pack photos on public social media.

Email, alerts and security

Phone alerts are off until you turn them on. Email is only for sign-in codes, a one-time welcome, the Sunday email, reminders, updates on your own payments and reimbursements, den messages, and announcements a leader chooses to email. No passwords to steal, everything encrypted, and the database is backed up nightly.

PART 1 · SECTION 1.5

Help and troubleshooting

I didn't get the sign-in email, or the link didn't sign me in

Check spam, and make sure you used the email the pack has for you. Sign-in emails are limited to 20 an hour for the whole pack, so wait a few minutes and try again. On phones, email links open your web browser, not the home-screen app: go back to the Pack 361 icon and type the 6-digit code. Still stuck? Email **info@pack361.org**.

"Not on the roster"

You signed in with an email the pack doesn't have. Sign out and use the email you gave the pack. New to the pack? Fill in **Ask to join the app** on that page (your name, and your scouts' names and grades). A pack admin checks it and adds you, and you get an email when you're in.

I'm not getting alerts

Turn them on in Me → Phone alerts, and tap **Send a test alert**. On iPhone, alerts only work from the home-screen app, and you have to allow notifications when asked.

A photo or receipt won't upload

iPhone "HEIC" photos can't be read by some browsers. Upload from the iPhone itself, or set the camera to Most Compatible (Settings → Camera → Formats). Big receipt photos are shrunk automatically; a PDF over 10 MB needs a smaller copy. Photos that fail stay in the list so you can try again.

A payment didn't show as paid

Most payments show as paid right away; dues paid on Givebutter within a day. If you closed the page during a PayPal checkout, the app checks with PayPal again within a day. Paid by check or cash? Tap **I paid another way** so the treasurer knows to look for it.

My saved files are gone

Files in **Saved on this phone** live only in the browser or home-screen app where you saved them. On iPhone, the home-screen app and Safari keep separate copies, and deleting the app deletes its files. Keep a backup with **Share → Save to Files**.

Something looks wrong

Use **Report a problem or send a note** under Me (or search for "problem"). It goes straight to the pack admins. The **Pack guide** in the app has more answers. Or email **info@pack361.org**, which is also how to correct or remove your family's information. When a family leaves the pack, their access is turned off.

Youth protection concern? Call the Scouts First Helpline, **1-844-SCOUTS1 (1-844-726-8871)**. In an emergency, call 911.

PART 2

For pack leaders

Den leaders, key leaders, the Cubmaster and pack admins get these tools on top of everything in Part 1. Den leaders work with their own dens; key leaders, the Cubmaster and admins work with the whole pack.

2.1 Who can do what	The five roles at a glance
2.2 Every leader	Events, den meetings, advancement, messages, gear
2.3 Key leaders: money	Dues, Givebutter, fees, registration
2.4 Key leaders: expenses and reports	Reimbursements, budget, financial reports
2.5 More leader tools	Help wanted, guide, council events, the year
2.6 Pack admin only	Roster, roles, imports, settings
2.7 Keeping the app secure	For every leader, and admins
2.8 Two-step sign-in	Every leader

PART 2 · SECTION 2.1

Who can do what

Every account has one role, set by a pack admin. Scouts don't have accounts. "Key leaders" look after the whole pack, like the chair and treasurer; together with den leaders they are the pack's leadership. Leader tools are in **Leader** mode (1.2).

Can…	Parent	Den leader	Key leader	Cubmaster / Admin
See the calendar, campouts, guide, photos, store	✓	✓	✓	✓
See own scouts' advancement, report home requirements	✓	✓	✓	✓
Answer polls, sign up to volunteer, upload photos	✓	✓	✓	✓
RSVP, pay the pack, read pack documents	✓	✓	✓	✓
Ask to be paid back, invite a family, borrow gear, offer help	✓	✓	✓	✓
Add, build, copy and edit events; add documents	–	✓	✓	✓
Approve advancement	–	**Own den**	**Whole pack**	**Whole pack**
Plan den meetings, take attendance	–	**Own den**	**Any den**	**Any den**
Post pack announcements, start pack polls	–	✓	✓	✓
Ready to go?, message families about an event, weather alerts	–	✓	✓	✓
Message a den, poll a den	–	**Own den**	**Any den**	**Any den**
Take attendance, see the attendance report	–	✓	✓	✓
Review photos, track paperwork, add volunteer jobs, handle gear requests	–	✓	✓	✓
Edit the Pack guide, pick council events, Help wanted jobs	–	✓	✓	✓
Money: dues, fees, payments, registration	–	–	✓	✓
Expenses: approve and pay back requests, budget, reports	–	–	✓ *	✓ *
Pack admin (roster, roles, imports, welcome emails, settings)	–	–	–	✓

* Never your own request: another key leader approves, pays, changes or deletes it. These rules are enforced inside the database, not just by hiding buttons, so they hold even if someone tries to get around the app.

Every leader

Leaders and youth protection: keep Safeguarding Youth training current (it's renewed every year now), never upload medical forms or personal details anywhere in the app, and never approve photos showing scouts whose families opted out.

Events and RSVPs

Add event (Home or Calendar), or **Edit** on any event: date and time (or all day), place, details, which dens or ranks it's for, a sign-up link, an optional **cost** (per scout, per adult or per family) and an RSVP-by date. RSVPs are on for every event unless you turn them off. The event page shows who's coming and the headcount, and a family that says Going to an event with a cost is billed for it automatically. For a campout, **Camping nights** fills itself in from the dates (Friday to Sunday is 2); type a number to change it. Tick **Show on the public join page**, with a line for visiting families, for events newcomers are welcome at (section 2.5).

Repeating events, copies and RSVP limits

On a new event, **Repeats** can be every week, every other week or monthly, **Until** a date; it adds one event per date. Editing one later? Tick **Also change the other upcoming events in this series** to change the name, time, place and details on all of them (each keeps its date). **Copy this event** (at the bottom of the event page) makes a new event on the date you pick with the same details, permission slip, schedule, packing list, info, links and volunteer jobs; RSVPs and the Signal group start fresh. **Limit** under RSVP caps scouts and adults together. Once it's full, families who say Going join a waitlist and move in on their own, in order, when spots open; **Who's coming (leaders only)** lists the waitlist in order. Families on the waitlist aren't billed until they're in.

Build this event

Tap **Build schedule, packing list and info** on a campout (or **Add schedule, info and links** on any event). Everything saves as you go, and families see it right away. **Schedule:** what's happening, the day and time, where. **Packing list:** items in groups; **Start from the standard list** for a campout. **Info sections:** a title, text and bullet items, Plain, **Good to know** (gold) or **Important** (red); tick **Tap-to-check list** for a scavenger hunt families tick off on their phones. **Links:** sign-up forms, maps and the like. **Start from a past campout or event** copies any of those four parts from an earlier one, with the schedule moved to this event's dates. **See it as families do** to check it.

Ready to go?

On any event that takes RSVPs, leaders see what the families going still need: **Medical forms**, **Permission slips**, **Not paid yet** and open **Volunteer jobs**, each naming the families. For an overnight it also checks that an adult going has current BALOO and Hazardous Weather training. Open a row, edit the message if you like, and tap **Remind these families** (or **Ask families going to help**): a phone alert, and an email if you tick it, to just those families, at most every 12 hours.

Messaging families about an event, and Signal groups

Message families on the event page lets you pick **Going**, **Going and maybe** (**Going, maybe and waitlist** when there is one) or **No answer yet**, for a rain-out or a last call for RSVPs. It goes as a phone alert, with an optional email (replies come to you). For a Signal group: in Signal, open the event's group, tap its name, then **Group link**; copy it, and turn on **Approve new members**. Paste it in the **Signal group** card on the event page: only leaders and families going see **Join the Signal group**, and messages to families going end "More in the Signal group."

Weather alerts

Each evening the app checks the Weather Service for events in the next three days that have an address. For a watch, warning or major advisory during the event, leaders get a phone alert (den leaders for pack-wide events and their own dens'; key leaders, the Cubmaster and admins for all). It opens the event, where you can message the families going. Families see the forecast and any warning on the event page.

Permission slips

On the event form, tick **Families sign a permission slip for each scout**. Edit the wording parents agree to, and add a due date or a printable form from Pack documents if you like. Families who say Going are reminded until they sign. The event page shows leaders who has a slip (families going first), the phone number to reach each parent that day, and **Paper slip in** for paper ones. Check it before you leave for the event.

Taking attendance at pack events and campouts

From the day of the event, its page has a **Take attendance** card: scouts by den, with families who said Going already ticked. Tap to fix it, then **Save**. **Pack → Attendance** shows every scout's den meetings, pack events and camping nights for the season (July to June), with a spreadsheet download.

Recording a den meeting

Tap **Record the … meeting** on Home. Then: **1.** tap the scouts who are there (families who RSVP'd "Going" are already checked), **2.** tap the adventure you worked on (the ones most scouts still need are on top) and its requirements, **3.** tap **Save**. That records attendance and the requirements for everyone there, ready for the advancement chair to enter in Scoutbook. Families of scouts who were there get a recap alert; families who missed it get how to finish at home. Planning meetings ahead is optional; families see planned meetings on their calendar and can RSVP.

Advancement approvals and awards

Scouts tab: approve or return requirements families report (they get an alert either way), see each den's progress grid and what to plan next. **Awards to hand out** is a Scout Shop shopping list: every loop, pin and rank patch earned and not yet awarded, by rank like the store's shelves, with a photo, the SKU number, how many and for whom. It also prints **bag labels** (Avery 5160, 5163 or 5164) and an awards-night sheet. **Enter in Scoutbook** lists approved items **by scout** or **by requirement**; the second view matches Scoutbook Plus's screen for marking one requirement for several scouts at once. On a computer it's laid out like Scoutbook, one block per adventure, with **Entered** for a scout or the whole adventure once it's in.

Announcements, den messages and polls

Post to the whole pack, with a phone alert and, when it matters, **Also email every family**. Or message one den's parents with a phone alert and an optional email (replies come to you). Den leaders message their own dens; key leaders and above, any den. Messages go to parents only, never to scouts. **Polls** go to the pack or a den, with one or several answers, one answer per family, a closing date, and results for everyone or leaders only.

Paperwork tracker

Pack → Medical forms: every scout and adult's form status by den. Check off paper forms as they come in. Before a campout, filter for missing and message those families.

Photo review

Approve or remove family uploads and handle removal requests. It lists the scouts whose families opted out, so you know whom to watch for; every other scout is OK. A leader's own uploads go straight into the album only after they confirm none of the opted-out scouts are in them; otherwise they wait for review too.

Documents

Documents → Add a document (PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, images; up to 10 MB) for everyone, leaders only, or one den. Never upload medical forms or anything with personal details.

Training

Pack → Training shows what each leader needs for their position and what's missing, plus a pack checklist (BALOO before any overnight, Hazardous Weather, water safety). **Safeguarding Youth is renewed every year.** **Me → My training** lists what's expiring and the modules for your position, with reminders 60, 30 and 7 days ahead. Dates come in from my.scouting every week.

Gear requests

Pack → Gear requests lists requests **Waiting for an answer**, **Ready to pick up** and **Out now** (with any overdue). **Approve**, **Decline** (with a note), **Mark picked up**, **Mark returned**, or **More time** for a new bring-back day; families get an alert when you approve or decline. **Add gear** or **Edit** items in the closet. New requests alert leaders whose position mentions the quartermaster or gear (with none, the admins and Cubmaster).

Volunteer jobs and the calendar

Add volunteer jobs to any event or campout. Take an event off the calendar, or put it back, from its page. Spent your own money on the den? **Pack → Get paid back**, with a photo of the receipt (1.3).

See the app as someone else

Under **Me → See the app as…**, see the app the way a parent, a den leader or a key leader sees it, using your own family. It only changes what you see, and switches off after 8 hours.

PART 2 · SECTION 2.3 · KEY LEADERS+

Key leaders: money

Pack → Money shows what every family owes and has paid this season: still owed, families who say they paid, paid, and online versus check and cash. Its tabs are **Charges**, **Pack dues**, **Registration**, **Add a fee** and **Settings**, with buttons for **Expenses** and **Reports** at the top.

Start of the year (July or August)

1. **Settings:** set the dues season (like 2026–27), pack dues per scout ($255) and the sibling discount ($10 off each brother or sister after the first; it's optional, so full price matches too). Pick the pack dues campaign on Givebutter. Fill in **Other ways to pay** (who checks are payable to, who takes cash); families see it on Pay the pack.
2. **Add a fee → Set up dues for 2026–27** adds one dues charge per active scout, full price for the first scout in a family and discounted after that. Run it again later for new scouts; nobody is charged twice.
3. **Registration:** set each scout's and leader's Scouting America expiration date (usually one shared date: tick everyone and set it once). Families renew and pay at my.scouting.org; the app reminds them 30, 7 and 0 days before.
4. **Expenses → Budget:** enter the season's budget (section 2.4).

Pack dues on Givebutter

Families pay dues on Givebutter as before. Each morning (or when you tap **Sync now** in Settings) the app matches each payment to the family by email and to the scouts by the names they typed, then marks those scouts' dues paid. Anything it can't place waits on the **Pack dues** tab: tap **Match to…**, pick the family and tick its scouts, or **Not dues** for a donation. Refunds happen in Givebutter; reopen the charge in the app and it stays open.

Every week or two

- **Families say paid:** when a check or cash arrives, tap **Confirm paid** (or **Confirm all**). **Not received** puts it back to owed.
- **Mark paid** on anything paid by check or cash that the family didn't report. **Waive** or **Cancel** what the pack won't collect.
- **Online payments to check** appears only when a PayPal payment didn't add up; look it up in PayPal.

Other fees

Event costs are billed automatically from RSVPs (paid charges never change; the list flags when an RSVP no longer matches what was paid). For anything else, **Add a fee**: a name, amount and due date for every family or scout, one den's families or scouts, leaders, one family or one person (anyone who already has that fee this season is skipped). Search and filter the **Charges** tab by kind, status, family or season, and **Download CSV** for the treasurer's records.

PayPal is optional. With the treasurer's PayPal keys added, families can pay fees with PayPal, Venmo or a card. Without them, families pay by check or cash and tap "I paid another way". Dues always go through Givebutter.

Key leaders: expenses and reports

Money → Expenses tracks what the pack spends and who needs paying back. **Money → Reports** turns it into the pack's financial picture. A number on the Money button shows requests waiting.

Reimbursement requests (Expenses → To review)

Each request shows who asked, what they bought, the amount, the date, how they'd like to be paid, their note and the **Receipt**. Requests sent more than 30 days after the purchase are flagged. For each one, pick the budget category, then:

- **Approve**: it moves to **Approved, to pay back** and counts as spent.
- **Approve and pay back** (or **Mark paid back** later): choose how (check, cash, PayPal, Zelle, Venmo, bank transfer), the date and the check number. They get an alert and an email.
- **Decline**: write the reason; it's sent to them.

You can't approve or pay back your own request; another key leader does. Any key leader whose roster position includes "Treasurer" gets an alert and an email for each new request (with no treasurer, the Cubmaster and admins do).

Pack spending and other income

- **Record an expense** for things the pack paid for directly (pack card, pack check, cash): what, amount, date, category, optional event and den, how it was paid, and the receipt. Choose a member under **Who paid?** to record something you'll pay back.
- **Other income** is for money the app doesn't see on its own: a sponsor's check, popcorn commission, bank interest. Dues, event fees and Givebutter are counted automatically, so don't enter them here.
- The **Expenses** tab lists everything by season, filterable by category and status, with **Edit** and **Delete**.

Budget

Expenses → Budget: pick the season and enter an amount for each money-in and money-out line (leave a line blank if it isn't budgeted); it shows the planned difference. Next season is in the list, so the new budget can go in during the spring. Rename categories to match the pack's budget, add new ones, or **Hide** ones you don't use (old reports keep them).

Financial reports

Money → Reports for a season (July to June) or any dates (a month, a quarter, one campout weekend):

- **Money in, money out and the difference**, then each by category, with the budget and what's left when the season has one.
- **How money came in** (Givebutter, PayPal, check, cash), **by month**, **by event** (did the campout pay for itself?) and **den spending**.
- **Still outstanding:** reimbursements approved but not paid, requests waiting for review, and what families still owe.
- **Print or save as PDF** for the committee meeting; **Summary (CSV)** and **Every transaction (CSV)** for spreadsheets and the treasurer's records.

Givebutter and PayPal amounts are what families paid, before those services' fees; record the fees as an expense under "Bank and payment fees" to count them. Requests waiting for review and declined ones aren't counted.

PART 2 · SECTION 2.5 · LEADERS

More leader tools

Help wanted

Pack → Help wanted is the board of grown-up jobs for the year. Under **For leaders**: **Add a job** (what it involves, and who questions go to; families see only the name), see who offered to help and their notes, **Close this job** (and say who's doing it), **Open it again**, or **Edit or delete**. An offer sends a phone alert to the job's contact, or to key leaders when there isn't one. **Volunteer jobs this season** counts each family's event job sign-ups since July 1 and lists who hasn't had a turn; only leaders see it.

Pack guide editing

Leaders edit and publish Pack guide pages from the app. Draft pages are visible to leaders only, with the parts still to fill in highlighted.

Council events

Events → Council events lists Baltimore Area Council and district events. Meetings, holidays and other districts are hidden by default, and Cub Scout events are marked. Tap **Add to our calendar** or **Skip**; den leaders can look but not add.

Recruiting and the public join page

The public page (app.pack361.org/join, and pack361.org once it points to the app) tells families about the pack and how to join. Events ticked **Show on the public join page** appear there under **Big events coming up**, with only the name, dates, place name and your line for visitors (never the address or details). Families share the page from **Invite a family**.

Documents for key leaders KEY LEADERS+

Key leaders can add documents for **key leaders only** (budgets, minutes in draft), and edit, archive or delete any document.

The year at a glance

When	In the app
July–August	Money → Settings for the new season; Set up dues; registration dates; enter the budget; check Pack → Training for everyone's renewals; post the year's jobs on Help wanted.
Before each campout	Event with cost, RSVP-by date and any limit; Build this event (or start from a past campout); volunteer jobs; the Ready to go? card for forms, slips, payments and BALOO. Afterward, take attendance so camping nights count.
Before big events	Tick "Show on the public join page" on the ones visitors are welcome at, and remind families to use Invite a family.
Every week or two	Confirm check and cash payments; match any pack dues waiting; review and pay back reimbursement requests.
Each committee meeting	Money → Reports for the season so far, printed or saved as PDF; what's still outstanding.
Fall	Registration renewals (the app reminds families 30, 7 and 0 days before).
Spring	Next season's budget in Expenses → Budget; Blue & Gold and crossover events.
June	Season report (July–June) for the year-end committee meeting and the treasurer's records.

PART 2 · SECTION 2.6 · ADMINS

Pack admin only

Pack admins and the Cubmaster see **Pack → Pack admin**. Nobody needs to touch the database for everyday roster changes. It also shows how much of the free plan's 1 GB of file storage photos, documents and receipts use.

Tool	What it does
Join requests	People who signed in with an email that isn't on the roster and asked to be added. Check they're a pack family, pick a new or existing family and each scout's den (suggested from their grade), and tap **Add to the roster**; they get an email and can sign in right away. Or decline with a note they'll see. Scouts' names are deleted from the request once it's answered. Admins get a phone alert and an email for each request.
Roster check	The roster doesn't update itself from Scoutbook. After new families register, at the start of each school year (when scouts move up) and when someone leaves, export the youth roster from Scoutbook Plus (CSV or Excel) and choose it here, on a computer. The app lists who's **new in Scoutbook** (add each one to a family with one click), who's **in a different den** (**Move all**), member IDs to save, scouts registered again, and scouts **not in the export** (turn them off after checking with the den leader). The file is read on your computer and never uploaded.
Families and scouts	Add and edit families, adults and scouts; move scouts between dens; turn off access when a family leaves (their data stays, they just can't sign in). Changing someone's email? Do it before they sign in: it's the only way into their account.
Roles and positions	Set each adult's app role (parent, den leader, key leader, Cubmaster or admin) and position title. Put "Treasurer" in the treasurer's position so reimbursement requests reach them, and "Quartermaster" in the quartermaster's so gear requests do.
Dens and den leaders	Add dens and assign their leaders. Dens show by rank (Lion, Tiger…); the Scoutbook den number stays on this page.
Welcome emails	Send each adult a one-time "the app is ready" email, in batches of up to 40 a day to stay within the free email plan. It shows who has signed in and how many have phone alerts on (**alerts on** by each name). **New families who could use a hand** lists families from the last 90 days with two or more Getting started steps still to do; a call or a word at the next meeting helps. The page also links a printable **"Get the pack app" QR sign** (app.pack361.org/get/qr).
Messages	Problems and notes families send with "Report a problem or send a note". Admins also get a phone alert and an email for each one.

TroopWebHost calendar	Only while the pack still uses TroopWebHost: syncs every afternoon, or tap **Sync now**. Events removed there move to the archive; nothing is deleted. Editing a synced event in the app takes it out of the sync.
Import training	Monthly (key leaders can too; the Committee Chair gets a reminder). Upload the my.scouting training report (CSV or Excel). Leaders are matched by member ID and name, and only newer dates are applied. The file is read on your computer and never stored.
Import Scoutbook	Upload the Scoutbook Plus advancement export, or read it straight from Scoutbook (**Compare**, then **Import**). Turn on **Every Sunday night** to do it weekly, with Safeguarding Youth dates.
Pack store	Sync Givebutter orders and choose which campaigns the store shows.
Weekly newsletter	Who gets the Sunday email: off, testing (only the leaders ticked) or every family. **See this week's** shows it as your family would get it; **Email it to me** sends you a copy. Switch to every family when TroopWebHost is cancelled.
Pack settings	Awards tracking start date, how long photos are kept (24 months), welcome emails per day, and **the pack's public page** (the link Invite a family shares; change it to https://pack361.org when that address points to the app). Dues and fee amounts are on **Pack → Money → Settings**.
Beta site	New features go to **beta.pack361.org** first. It shows the pack's real information, but only the testers you tick here (and admins) can sign in, and its emails and alerts reach testers only. When a version is ready it's released to everyone; the version number is at the bottom of Me.
Nightly jobs	Reminders, weather checks, gear reminders, photo clean-up and calendar syncs run every evening. If a step fails, Pack admin shows which one and why.

PART 2 · SECTION 2.7 · LEADERS

Keeping the app secure

The app holds families' contact details and scouts' records, so it's built in layers, and leaders keep it that way. It was last security-reviewed in October 2026 (version 1.4); the review is repeated every year.

How it's protected

- **No passwords.** Everyone signs in with a one-time code sent to their email, so there's no password to steal or reuse. That makes **your email account the key** to your app account.
- **Two locks on everything.** The app checks who you are before showing a page or saving anything, and the database checks again on its own. Even someone who got around the app couldn't read or change what their role doesn't allow.
- **Only what you need.** Parents see only their own family. Den leaders see the scouts they work with. Money is for key leaders; the roster is for admins. Nobody signed out sees anything but the public join page.
- **Private files.** Photos, documents and receipts are never public: each opens through a link that works for a few minutes. Medical forms are never uploaded.
- **Limits.** Sign-in codes, messages to the admins and uploads have daily limits per person, so no one account can flood the admins, use up the pack's email allowance or fill its file storage.
- **Safe testing and backups.** New features are tried first on a testers-only beta site that can't email anyone else, and the database is backed up nightly.

What every leader should do

- **Turn on two-step sign-in for the email account you use for the app** (Gmail, Outlook and others all offer it). Anyone who can read your email can sign in as you.
- **Never share a sign-in code or link.** The pack will never ask for one. If someone does, it's a scam.
- **Spot fake emails.** Real app emails come from **noreply@pack361.org**, and their only buttons say **Open the Pack 361 app** (or my.scouting.org) and go to **app.pack361.org**. A button pointing anywhere else isn't from the pack.
- **Sign out on shared computers** (Me → Sign out).
- **Keep your calendar link private.** Shared it by mistake? **Events → Add the pack calendar → Get a new link**.
- **Upload only what belongs.** No medical forms, Social Security numbers, bank details or anything else sensitive in documents, messages or receipts.
- **Say something** about anything odd: **Report a problem** or info@pack361.org.

For admins ADMINS

- **When a leader steps down:** change their role in Families and scouts. Taking someone off a den sets them back to parent automatically if they lead no other den; turning off a family names any leaders still on.
- **The accounts behind the app** (GitHub, Vercel, Supabase, Squarespace, Resend, Brevo, Givebutter) each need two-step sign-in and two owners. Someone in one of them could change the app itself.
- **Keys:** change any key a departing person could see (handover guide, section 2). Brevo's keys expire every year in September.
- **Every year:** repeat the security review (docs/SECURITY-REVIEW.md in the code) and run Supabase's Security Advisor.

If you think something's wrong: 1. turn off the person's access (Families and scouts); 2. change the secret keys (handover guide, section 2); 3. look at Supabase's sign-in logs to see what happened; 4. restore from a backup if information was damaged (docs/RESTORE.md); 5. tell the Committee Chair and Cubmaster, and the families affected if their information may have been seen.

PART 2 · SECTION 2.8 · LEADERS

Two-step sign-in

Leaders can see every family's details and every scout, so every leader signs in with two things: the code emailed to them, and a code from an **authenticator app** on their phone. Someone who got into your email still couldn't get in as you. Until you've set it up, you get a parent's access. Parents sign in with just the email code.

Setting it up (once, about two minutes)

1. **Install an authenticator app** on your phone if you don't have one. Any works, all free: Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, or the one in your password manager (1Password, iPhone Passwords).
2. **Sign in to the app as usual.** It shows **Protect your leader account**. Tap **Set up two-step sign-in**.
3. **Add Pack 361 to your authenticator app.** On a computer, scan the QR code with your phone (in the authenticator app: **+** or **Add**, then **Scan a QR code**). On your phone, tap **Open it in your authenticator app**, or type the setup key it shows.
4. **Enter the 6-digit code** the authenticator app now shows for Pack 361, and tap **Finish setup**. You're in.

Until you set it up, the app shows that page every time you open it, and you only have a parent's access (in the app and in the database).

Signing in after that

- After the email code, the app asks for the code from your authenticator app. Codes change every 30 seconds: enter the one showing now.
- You're asked **once per device**, until you sign out. Opening the app again on the same phone doesn't ask again.
- **Code not working?** Check your phone's date and time are set automatically; authenticator codes depend on the clock.

Don't get locked out

- **Add a backup:** Me → **Two-step sign-in** → **Add another authenticator app**, on a tablet, a second phone or your password manager. Either app's code works. You can remove one there once you have two.
- **New phone?** Add the new phone there *before* you wipe the old one, or move your authenticator app's accounts across (Google Authenticator and Microsoft Authenticator can transfer them).
- **Lost your phone?** Email info@pack361.org. An admin opens **Pack admin** → **Two-step sign-in** and taps **Reset** next to your name: you're signed out everywhere and set it up again at your next sign-in.

For admins ADMINS

- **Pack admin** → **Two-step sign-in** lists everyone who needs it: **Set up** (with how many apps and when they last used a code), **Not set up yet**, or **Hasn't signed in yet**. Making someone a den leader, key leader or admin turns it on for them.
- **Reset** only after checking it's really them (a phone call or in person), since whoever sets it up next gets their access.
- **If every admin is locked out**, the handover guide (section 7) explains how to reset an account from Supabase.

VERSION HISTORY

What changed, and when

Each time the app gains a feature people will notice, this guide gets a new version. The latest copy is always at **app.pack361.org/app-guide** (Pack → How to use this app).

Version	Date	What's new
3.1–3.3	Oct 4–5, 2026	**Carpool**; **Trail guide** and **Nature ID**: bird song and plant ID in the app; **Right now** weather during events (1.3).
3.0.2	October 3, 2026	**Two-step sign-in for den leaders** (2.8); **Key leaders** role, with den leaders running the guide, Help wanted and council events; RSVP buttons show your answer (1.3).
3.0	October 3, 2026	**Photos are OK unless a family opts out** (1.3, 1.4, 2.2). Families: **Getting started** list (1.1), **Add to my calendar**, weather, RSVP limits and **waitlists**, reminders, advancement alerts, the Sunday email's **Your scout this week**, **Gear closet**, **Help wanted**, **Season keepsake** (1.3). Leaders: **Build this event**, copy and repeating events, **Ready to go?**, messages to who hasn't answered, weather alerts, gear requests (2.2); Help wanted jobs (2.5); new families on Welcome emails (2.6).
2.3–2.5	October 3, 2026	**Signal group** on events and **Message families going**; **Leader mode** by default for leaders; photo swipe and zoom; faster loading, a tap-to-check scavenger hunt and one-click sign-in on computers (1.1–1.3, 2.2).
2.2	October 2, 2026	Advancement and training **straight from Scoutbook**, weekly (Scouts → Import).
2.1	October 2, 2026	**Dark mode** (Me → Appearance).
2.0	October 2, 2026	**Redesign:** five fixed tabs (Home, Calendar, Scouts, Pack, Me), search, a **Family / Leader** switch for leaders, Calendar filters, and quick links on event pages (1.2).
1.5	October 2, 2026	**Two-step sign-in** for leadership and admins (2.8). **Popcorn** page (1.3). **Monthly training import** (2.2, 2.6).
1.4	October 2, 2026	**Security review**: safer email links, limits on messages and uploads, **Get a new link** for the calendar feed (1.3). New section **2.7**.
1.3	October 1, 2026	**Get the pack app**: a QR code and a page (app.pack361.org/get) for adding the app to a phone (1.1, 2.6). A **beta site** for testers (2.6).
1.2	October 1, 2026	**Awards to hand out**: a Scout Shop shopping list with SKUs, plus **bag labels** (2.2).
1.1	October 1, 2026	**Permission slips**, **Ask to join the app**, **Roster check**, **See the app as…**, and position training modules (1.3, 1.5, 2.2, 2.6).
1.0	September 2026	First edition: Part 1 for every family, Part 2 for leaders.